Volume 11
Issue 7
July 1, 2026

THE MONTHLY NEWSLETTER FOR RESIDENTS OF THE MPII CDD

MPII NEWS



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Meadow Pointe II Clubhouse

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813-991-5016

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Facebook.com/MPIICDD

Operations Manager

Justin Wright
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Office Hours

Daily 8am—8:45pm

Fitness Center

M-F 7am—8:45pm
S/S 8am—8:45pm

Pool

Daily 9am—30 minutes before dusk

Playground

Daily 9am—30 minutes before dusk

Courts

Daily 8am—8:45pm



As 'Old Glory' flies in front of the MPII Clubhouse, this month we celebrate the 250th anniversary of the formation of our great nation. We mark 250 years since we formally submitted our Declaration of Independence. Happy birthday America! For more about America's 250th, see the feature on page 2.

MPII CDD Board of Supervisors

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The CDD Board of Supervisors holds public meetings twice each month. These are held on the 1st and 3rd Wednesdays at 6:30 pm in the Clubhouse.

All MPII residents are welcomed and encouraged to attend. This is your CDD and attending meetings is the best way to stay informed and share your input.

America's 250th!

This year's 4th of July will be a very special Independence Day, as it is the 250th birthday of our great nation. For those that enjoy S.A.T. words – it is America's semiquincentennial anniversary.



And while political divisiveness is rampant, hopefully this year's Independence Day, marking a major milestone year, can be a unifying force. A way to reflect on all that happened prior to 1776 and just as importantly, all that has happened since. A great deal went into building this country, and multiple wars were fought and many died to make this happen.

One great way to commemorate our nation's 250th anniversary would be to learn more about all the things that went into creating and growing our country. A great place to research this is the Gilder Lehrman Institute of American History. Their website caters to educators, but anyone can use these resources to learn about our nation's past. Another great resource is The National Constitution Center. That site is a phenomenal resource for learning about the constitution, gaining multiple diverse perspectives on issues, and watching reasoned debate about countless issues facing our nation.

If you prefer watching videos, famed author John Green (*The Fault in Our Stars* and more), hosts multiple educational video series on YouTube, including a fantastic series of videos on U.S. history through the Crash Course channel. If you're a little more old school, a terrific book to read is Thirteen American Arguments: Enduring Debates That Inspire and Define Our Country by Howard Fineman (political journalist).

In addition to learning more about our great country, you might want other ways to celebrate and commemorate the 250th. In that case, all over Tampa there is a plethora of great activities. Busch Gardens is celebrating America through July 5th with all their usual family fun, plus special military offers, patriotic merchandise and commemorative souvenirs, Americana inspired food, and fireworks shows with patriotic themes. Also, the City of Tampa is hosting Liberty by the Bay, a drone light show featuring 250 drones followed by a spectacular fireworks finale on the 4th of July. The event kicks off at 4 pm with a Kids Zone, food trucks, vendors, live music, and more.

The Tampa Bay History Center is open on July 4th and included with gallery admission are hourly screenings of the Smithsonian Channel documentary "A Star -Spangled Story: Battle for America". The following weekend, on Sunday, July 12th, from 4-7pm the Centro Asturiano de Tampa is celebrating America's...

America's 250th continues on page 4...

CDD Updates

Loyal readers of our newsletter will recall that the CDD Board has begun posting their own updates on their projects utilizing the MPII CDD website. Their updates can be found under the 'Information' tab, by clicking 'Project Pipeline'. However, many residents might not be periodically deep diving into our community website, so the *MPII News* will continue to provide occasional updates such as this article!

After all, there is a lot of exciting news regarding a few developing projects. Firstly, and probably closest to breaking ground, is the new MPII Dog Park! All plans have been accepted by the Pasco County permitting department and the final stages of landscaping and irrigation are underway. The park will consist of a small parking lot, as well as two dog sections – one 2660 square foot area for large dogs and a 2350 square foot area for small dogs. Hopefully construction will begin in earnest very soon.

Next, but also on the near-future horizon, is the long-awaited lap pool. The MPII CDD has a contract for a design-to-build with an engineering firm and Martin Aquatics. It will be a zero-entry pool with 5 lanes for lap swimming. By the time you read this, the CDD Board may have a ground-breaking date in place for construction, but at the time of this writing, a date was not yet set.

Lastly, the new building on the lot in front of the Kids R Kids location. The construction of the new building has presented many curveballs. First there were post-Covid delays, supply chain delays, permitting delays, and a few other quirky issues. Unfortunately, by the time these issues were resolved or otherwise overcome, costs had risen. And there are legal implications that come with projects financed through bonds. Our CDD Board has always strived to maintain fiscal integrity as well as transparency, so they have been working diligently behind the scenes to find a way to move forward with the new building project while adhering to all laws and being financially responsible to the bond and the residents of MPII.

Consequently, this project is still in development. But the Board is optimistic that construction will happen sometime soon. The plan currently will include an event space that can accommodate up to 135 people, that can be split into two smaller spaces. The new building will also have internet, a backup...

CDD Updates continues on page 5...

July MPII Trivia

Trivia – While July 4th is the 250th anniversary of our nation's founding, it's also the 200th anniversary of the deaths of two of our founding fathers! Which two founders died on July 4th, 1826?

Answer on page 4.

MPII Management Company

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The MPII Clubhouse offers MPII residents Notary Services at no cost.

We have a certified Notary on staff, please call ahead for availability.

America's 250th!

Continued from page 2

250th with America 250: A Salute to Service and Shared Heritage. This event will honor our past, celebrate our freedom, and thank our heroes.

If you prefer to stay very close to home, there are still some great ways to celebrate here in the Wesley Chapel area. On July 3rd at 7pm there will be an America 250 Patriotic Concert at the Instructional Performing Arts Center at Pasco Hernando State College. For additional Pasco County celebrations, check out the Pasco County website.

No matter how you choose to celebrate and commemorate this momentous semiquincentennial, please be safe. If you're going to consume alcohol, have a designated driver. If you're venturing out, keep yourself and your family safe and be extra cautious on the roads. If you're using fireworks or sparklers, please



be very safe. On a typical 4th of July holiday, about 91,000 Americans visit U.S. emergency rooms. This year experts anticipate higher numbers. Have fun, but be smart, be prepared, and stay safe!

And perhaps most importantly, remember that in our ever-divisive world, take time to be grateful for the good in our country, and in your life personally. Neither our nation, nor any of us individually are perfect. But we can all strive to do better and be better. The preamble to the U.S. Constitution reads "We the People of the United States, in Order to form a more perfect Union, establish Justice, insure domestic Tranquility, provide for the common defense, promote the general Welfare, and secure the Blessings of Liberty to ourselves and our Posterity, do ordain and establish this Constitution for the United States of America." ALL of those words were chosen carefully and they are all important. The founders knew we needed to continue to strive to improve – to form a more perfect Union. So hopefully on America's 250th anniversary, we can all focus on the positives and celebrate. Then the next day we can all get back to work trying to live up to the words of that preamble.

Happy 250th Anniversary America!

Trivia Answer (from page 3): John Adams and Thomas Jefferson!

John Adams and Thomas Jefferson both passed away on the 50th anniversary of our great country. Long-time friends, occasional political rivals, and both former presidents, the two died hours apart on the 50th anniversary of the Declaration of Independence, which they both helped author. Due to slow communication of the era, when Adams died, his reported last words were, "Jefferson still lives." But Jefferson had died a few hours earlier.

https://blogs.loc.gov/headlinesandheroes/2022/07/deaths-of-john-adams-and-thomas-jefferson-on-july-4th/

July Holidays



4th – Independence Day. Today all Americans unite to celebrate the birth of our great nation – the anniversary of our Declaration of Independence. Although the Second Continental Congress created our new nation on July 2nd, 1776, it took an additional two days to settle on the wording of and formally approve the Declaration of Independence. The first 4th of July fireworks display took place on the one-year anniversary (1777) in Philadelphia. Happy 250th birthday to the U.S.A.!



14th – Bastille Day. Bastille Day, or French National Day, commemorates the critical turning point in the French Revolution. Our key ally in the Revolutionary War, France was in an ugly internal conflict by 1789. On July 14th, citizens, rebels, and several mutinous members of the French Guard stormed the Bastille – which was a fortress/prison. They freed the political prisoners held there and acquired the stored weapons and gunpowder. This success led to the official end of feudalism in France by August 4th. By the end of August, France had proclaimed their pivotal document: The Declaration of the Rights of Man and of the Citizen, which would serve as the preamble to the French Constitution two years later.



23rd – Tisha B'Av. Beginning at sundown on the 22nd and lasting until nightfall on the 23rd, the Jewish community worldwide honors a 25 hour fast and several other sacrifices to commemorate their "saddest day", a day in their calendar where five different calamities occurred on this same date on their calendar. For those that participate, have a blessed fast on this solemn day.

CDD Updates

Continued from page 3

generator, and an audio-video system. It will also include a small office, kitchenette, restrooms, and a separate conference room for small meetings.

The additional maintenance building (for staff only) will be capable of storing maintenance vehicles as well as bulk supplies such as rock, sand, and dirt used periodically for repairs (especially for repairing pond shorelines). This building will enable the MPII Clubhouse maintenance staff to store as much of this as possible without it being an eyesore for residents while keeping it safe from the elements.



Future site of the MPII Dog Park, just southwest of the intersection of Iverson Drive and Baythorn Drive.

The CDD Board thanks all MPII residents for their support and patience as these projects come to fruition. Things like this are often a long and slow process, but many CDD projects over the last few years have been taken care of with great efficiency and these three bigger projects are getting close. The Board is doing what they can to make MPII an even better place to live!

Summer Heat Safety

It's July, and summer officially started back on June 21st. But we live in Tampa Bay, and the Florida heat has been here for a while, but for the next two to three months it will be relentless! Everyone in the U.S. knows that Florida is called the Sunshine State for a good reason. Everyone knows it is hot here for most of the year. Anyone who's active on Facebook has inevitably seen numerous versions of "Florida's Seasons" memes. While several of those memes are clever and quite funny, the Florida heat is no laughing matter.



According to the Florida Policy Institute, our state has the highest number of heat-related illness in the country – with 31,011 ER visits and hospitalizations between 2018 and 2022. A University of Florida study recorded 215 fatalities linked to environmental heat between 2010 and 2020 in our state alone. These illnesses and deaths affect people of all ages. While older Floridians are more susceptible and less resistant to the heat and dehydration, younger people don't concern themselves about the heat as much as they should and overexert themselves.

These numbers are alarming, but nearly all these illnesses and deaths are preventable. The key is to be prepared, and be smart, whenever you're going to be outdoors in the Florida heat. Obviously never leave pets or children in a hot car – even for a few minutes. Drink lots of fluids, but not with caffeine or alcohol. Wear loose, light colored clothes. If you're doing *anything* physical, take frequent breaks. Be aware of the weather forecasts and when the heat will be at its peak.

When you come to use the amenities at the MPII Clubhouse, know that we have a water fountain in the Clubhouse for individual use – or to fill/refill your own reusable container. Obviously, the pool is also a great way to cool off, even though the water gets fairly warm in the summer. But whether your outdoor activities are in your yard, at the MPII amenities, or throughout the beautiful Tampa Bay Area, please do what you can to beat the heat and stay safe. With common sense, plus some tips, and a little preparation, you can ensure that you stay healthy this summer in the hot Florida sun.

https://www.cdc.gov/climate-health/php/resources/protect-yourself-from-the-dangers-of-extreme-heat.html

https://www.redcross.org/get-help/how-to-prepare-for-emergencies/types-of-emergencies/extreme-heat-safety.html?srsltid=AfmBOooFWqkym_OAojVaOkpfP2JRyawQI8OL4sfE_2kOUIfBteWhOOh7

Upcoming MPII EPC Events

The EPC has no imminent plans, largely due to summer heat, but they are hard at work preparing for an active run before the end of 2026! First up this fall is the Keep Pasco Beautiful Community Cleanup. This event will take place on Saturday, September 19th. We do these events several times a year and it's a great opportunity to get some steps in while working with your neighbors to beautify your community! This is also a fantastic opportunity for high school students to accumulate a few more volunteer hours needed for Florida Bright Futures Scholarships (and others). There will be more information about this as the date gets closer, but if you know you're interested, please feel free to email epc@mpiicdd.org and let us know!

Coming in October is the MPII Halloween Festival, a family favorite every year. We will need a LOT of volunteers for this amazing event. And we hope to see every MPII family out at the Clubhouse grounds for all the attractions! As with the cleanup, more details will be advertised as the event gets closer, so stay tuned.

All EPC events depend on community involvement. We welcome volunteers of all ages (whole families are welcome!) and you can email us if you are interested in future volunteer opportunities.

Summer Reading Quest

With so many families in MPII, parents are often looking for things for the kids to do all summer long. One great activity that kids of any age can do while staying out of the peak heat of the summer is READING!

The Pasco County Library System hosts a summer reading program every year. This year it is themed with America's 250th anniversary and it is called Star Spangled Stories Summer Reading Quest. This program runs through August 2nd, so there's still over a month left to participate.

With – at long last – a Pasco library finally open right here in Wesley Chapel – this is a great opportunity to head over there and check out some books. And not just for the kids – for the whole family. Adults should read for pleasure – studies show that only 16% of adults read for pleasure on any given day. Ironically, studies also show multiple benefits in adults who read for pleasure. It reduces stress, improves cognitive function, improves memory, and benefits sleep patterns.

So, head to our new library, or participate online in the Summer Reading Quest. Get the kids involved, as well as all the adults in the house! It's a great way to keep your minds active and sharp, lower stress, improve sleep, and most importantly – have fun!

MPII Clubs & Opportunities

TEACH LEAF is enrolling for the 2026-2027 school year! The Kindergarten Learning Pod will meet on Mondays and Wednesdays and the Emerging Readers Pod will meet on Tuesdays. This is a great opportunity for the Homeschool families in our community! For more details or to enroll in the Pod, please contact Melissa Goebel at teacher.melissa827@gmail.com.

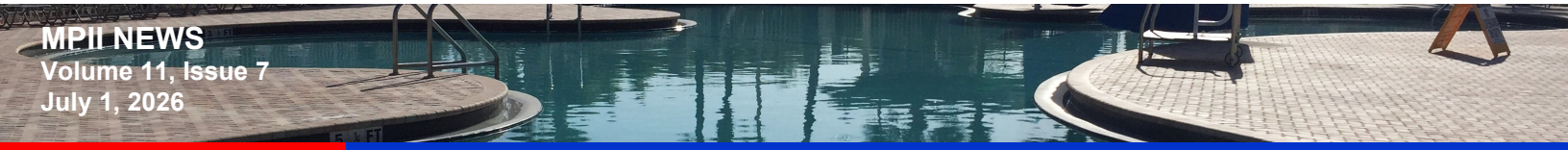
Radiant Senior Social Day will be held every Tuesday from 10:30 am—1:30 pm at the MPII Clubhouse with music, games,



and activities for senior residents to enjoy friendship, creativity, and community. Reserve your spot with Vicki at 813-997-3379.

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MPII News Needs Your Photos!

If you have taken a photo within MPII that you think would make a nice cover shot on a future issue, please email it to newsletter@mpiicdd.org. Submitting a photo gives us permission to use it in the newsletter. If there are people in the photo, please ensure that we have their permission to publish their photo.

Also, remember that the Clubhouse has an opt-in email list for receiving a link to the newsletter PDF each month! And, effective 6/1/26 this is the MAIN way to receive our community newsletter. To opt-in, just email newsletter@mpiicdd.org and tell us what email address or addresses you'd like us to include. As of now, the Clubhouse only uses this list for the newsletter, but we may include other time-sensitive announcements in the future.